

Litoria caerulea

Australian green treefrog



Length 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding season Spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location S. New Guinea, N. and E. Australia



Also known as White's treefrog, this widespread Australasian species is well known for its tame behavior, and its habit of living in or near buildings. Its color varies from green to greenish blue, sometimes with white spots. Like most tree frogs, it has adhesive disks on its toes. In wet conditions, its

loose, deeply folded skin allows the frog to take in a large amount of water—an ability that makes it unusually tolerant of drought. The Australian green treefrog is a nocturnal hunter, preying on insects and other invertebrates, and occasionally larger animals, such as mice. Males are smaller than females, and give out a harsh, barklike courtship call. After mating, the female lays 2,000–3,000 eggs in water. These frogs are of considerable interest in medicine: their skin produces several useful antibacterial and antiviral compounds, and a substance that has been used to treat high blood pressure in humans.



Litoria infrafrenata

White-lipped treefrog



Length 4–5½ in (10–14 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location New Guinea, N.E. Australia



Plain green above, with a distinctive stripe along its lower lip, this tropical species is the largest frog in Australia, and one of the biggest tree frogs in the world. Found in forests and gardens, it feeds after dark on insects and other invertebrates. It has large adhesive disks on its toes, and spends most of its life in trees. During the breeding season, adults descend and females lay up to 400 eggs in water.



Litoria australis

Giant frog



Length 2¾–4¼ in (7–10.5 cm)
Habit Terrestrial/Burrowing
Breeding season Rainy season
Status Least concern

Location N. Australia



This large frog is able to survive underground for very long periods by burrowing into the soil and shedding numerous layers of skin, which create a cocoon around its body. It can retain large amounts of water in its bladder, body cavity, and beneath its skin. A related species, the water-holding frog (*L. platycephala*), is used as a “living well” by aborigines, who dig up the frog and extract drinking water by squeezing it. The giant frog is pale gray, brown, or bright green in color, with a dark brown or black stripe through its eyes. It has a broad head, short, muscular limbs, horny tubercles on its hind feet, and a pair of skin folds on its back. During the breeding season, they are active during the day and can be found beside temporary pools where males call to females from the water's edge. Once they have mated, each female lays up to 7,000 eggs in clumps that sink to the bottom of the pond. The tadpoles are very resilient and can survive water temperatures of up to 109°F (43°C).

Pseudacris crucifer

Spring peeper



Length ¾–1½ in (2–3.5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring
Status Least concern

Location S.E. Canada, E. USA



Across much of eastern North America, the distinctive call of this tiny but highly agile frog is a sign that spring is under way. It belongs to a group of species known as chorus frogs, which are adept climbers, with reduced webbing, and adhesive disks on their toes. The spring peeper lives in woodland with temporary or permanent ponds, spending winter and dry spells under logs or rotting vegetation.



INFLATED VOCAL SAC



Male spring peepers gather in shrubs and trees next to water in early spring to form choruses, giving out high, piping whistles to attract females. The male's vocal sac amplifies his call as the air is passed back and forth between the sac and lungs over the vocal cords.

Hyla cinerea

Green treefrog



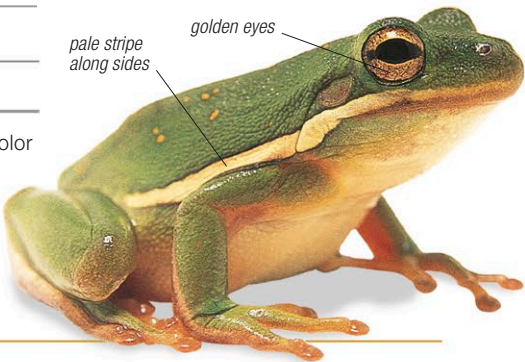
Length 1¼–2¼ in (3–6 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding season Spring
Status Least concern

Location S.E. USA



This bright green frog can change color quite rapidly, from yellow when calling out for mates, to gray when the weather is cold. In the breeding season, males form choruses around pond edges; some call out to attract mates,

while others, called “satellite males,” are silent and attempt to intercept females attracted to the calling males. This species is also known as the “rain frog,” because it calls just before and during wet weather. It often appears at night at windows, where it feeds on insects attracted to the light.



Hyla arborea

Common treefrog



Length 1¼–2 in (3–5 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding season Spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location Europe, W. Asia



Europe is home to just a few species of tree frogs—this one is the most widespread. Usually bright green, although sometimes yellow or brown, it has

a conspicuous dark horizontal stripe on its head and body. It lives in overgrown areas near water, and hibernates in winter. During the breeding season, males make a loud quacking sound, and this can quickly build up into a noisy chorus.

